Leading mindful transformation

HSO, the transformation company, found the able hands of Prabhat Nagaraj to steer its foray into India and the Philippines. Already well-established globally, Prabhat's experience and reputation played a huge role in building the brand in Asia. He discusses taking ownership, and leading by example.



Prabhat Nagaraj
Managing Director, HSO, India & Philippines

Currently the Managing Director for HSO India & Philippines, Prabhat Nagaraj has a veritable experience across his illustrious career. He spent almost 20 years in the USA where he led diverse teams across various organisations such as Microsoft, Hitachi, DXC, Amazon and RSM. He started his career as a consultant and grew into a leadership role at Hitachi where he was the Vice President for the Americas. His ability to provide solutions saw him evolve into a role where he managed the entire Microsoft Dynamics services team in DXC Americas. His reputation preceded him before he took up his current role in India.

RINGING IN THE RIGHT CHANGE

"I knew it would be challenging, but it was also in many unexpected ways," says Prabhat, about transitioning into his current role. The first few months of Prabhat's stint at HSO saw him playing an active role in ensuring the right talents were working on the right projects.

Prabhat believes that every individual intends to do their best, and that is why they show up to work. If, for some reason, they find themselves unable to achieve their professional goals, Prabhat is the kind of leader who starts by identifying the cause. "It is my responsibility to provide the right opportunity for every individual, and ensure that person feels good about doing the job they set out to do in the first place," he says.

Prabhat takes a keen interest in the humans behind the employees, understands their needs and aspirations, and has transformed many careers for the better. He also believes that the more an individual grows, the more the organisation grows, and therefore so does an entire industry.

"NEVER TOO LATE TO ACQUIRE SKILLS"

"I was not born with them, most of them have been acquired" says Prabhat, as he talks about some of the most valuable skills he has honed in the diverse roles he has held. As a young consultant, he found there was a need to constantly 'do'. He worked with one of the top leaders in the industry back then, and began to notice that even in the event of a conflict, the latter would do nothing. Sometimes, to the point that the lack of action would frustrate Prabhat. Slowly, a lesson unfolded. He came to realise that even when something wrong was happening, the best action may not necessarily be to 'take action'. "The fact that you do not act, is an act in itself," he says.

TRANSFORMING WORK WITHIN

Prabhat's role as Managing Director for HSO's operations in India and the Philippines started right in the middle of the pandemic. In a short span of time, Prabhat has led necessary policy changes for safe and inclusive hiring practices, a hybrid work culture, benefits that include insurance for the individual and their families, and also the opportunity to upskill.

Today, when professionals are hired at HSO, they are proactively given a career path. Not only are they provided with the right mentorship, but also with the right resources to upskill in their chosen fields of work. "I want to inspire people to be their best everyday," says Prabhat.

Prabhat is optimistic about his current role. Over the course of his career, his roles required him to develop a microscopic look into understanding what went into making large teams function, and the challenges that came with it. He continues to achieve a consistent symbiosis between technology and individuals. As someone who believes in the union of individuals and the organisation by a vision, Prabhat is truly a leader to reckon with.